

Exercises

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta 1 a) (1,2): a(1)^2 + b(1) + c &= 3 \rightarrow a + b + c = 3 \\ (2,5): a(2)^2 + b(2) + c &= 5 \rightarrow 4a + 2b + c = 5 \\ (3,3): a(3)^2 + b(3) + c &= 3 \rightarrow 9a + 3b + c = 3 \end{aligned}$$

$$\Delta f[x_0/x_1] = \frac{5-3}{2-1} = 2$$

$$\Delta f[x_1/x_2] = \frac{3-5}{3-2} = -2$$

$$\Delta f[x_0/x_1/x_2] = \frac{-2-2}{3-1} = -\frac{4}{2} = -2$$

$$\Delta p_2(x) = f[x_0] + f[x_0/x_1](x-x_0) + f[x_0/x_1/x_2](x-x_0)(x-x_1)$$

$$\Delta p_2(x) = 3 + 2(x-1) - 2(x-1)(x-2)$$

$$\Delta p_2(x) = -2x^2 + 8x - 3$$

$$\Delta b) p_2'(x) = 0$$

$$\Delta -4x + 8 = 0$$

$$\Delta 4x = 8$$

$$\Delta x_{max} = 2$$

$$\Delta c) 3(2^2-3^2) + 5(3^2-1^2) + 3(1^2-2^2)$$

$$\Delta = 3(4-9) + 5(9-1) + 3(1-4) = 16$$

$$\Delta 2[3(2-3) + 5(3-1) + 3(1-2)] = 8$$

$$\Delta x_{max} = 16/8 = 2 \quad \checkmark$$

Computer lab

1a) x_i	$f(x_i)$	1st diff	2nd diff	3rd diff	4th diff
1	1	0			
2	1		0.5		
3	2	1		1/3	
4	6	4	1.5		2/8
5	24	18	7	11/6	

(c) Largest errors occur at the edges of the domain, specifically when $x < 1$ and $x > 5$ because the polynomial and cubic spline are forced to extrapolate outside the convex hull of the data. This is because of Runge's phenomenon.

Initial AI Prompt Used

“Write a MATLAB script to interpolate data points for the gamma function and plot the results along with their absolute errors.

Here is the setup and the data:

$X=[1,2,3,4,5]$

$Y=[1,1,2,6,24]$

The evaluation domain for plotting is $x \in [0.5, 5.5]$. Use 1000 points for a smooth curve”